

User Feedback / Formative Evaluation 4

1 Session overview

Project stage: Late-development prototype

Session date: 2026-5-11

Duration: Approximately 30 minutes

Participant: 1 user from our intended target group

Method: Guided walkthrough + think-aloud feedback during task exploration

2 Participant profile

The participant had prior experience with GitHub and web-based developer tools, but had not previously seen this application. Feedback therefore reflects genuine first impressions of the current state of the prototype rather than familiarity with earlier iterations.

3 Goal of the session

The session aimed to evaluate whether improvements from the first session were effective, and to surface any remaining usability issues in the near-final prototype:

- Whether the onboarding and repository connection flow is clear and efficient.
- Whether the dashboard communicates information and status effectively.
- Whether goal-related workflows are easy to discover and complete.
- Whether the overall user experience is pleasant and satisfying to use.

4 Tasks / walkthrough focus

The participant explored and commented on the following modules:

1. **Onboarding & GitHub Login**
Connection flow, first impressions
2. **Repository Selection**
Recent repositories display, linking workflow
3. **Dashboard**
Layout, information clarity, available actions
4. **Goal Management**
Discoverability, creation flow, navigation
5. **Overall Experience**
Visual design, ease of use, satisfaction

5 Main feedback from the participant

The participant reported an overall positive experience. The application was described as intuitive and visually pleasant. Specific observations are recorded below.

Onboarding & Repository Connection

- Connecting a GitHub account was straightforward and required no guidance.
- The immediate display of recent repositories after authentication was appreciated; it reduced the effort required to locate and connect a repository.
- Linking a repository was described as intuitive and required no explanation.

Dashboard

- The dashboard layout was perceived as clean and easy to navigate.
- The participant found the information presented on the dashboard to be well-organised and immediately understandable.

Goal Management

- The participant took some time to locate the goal creation feature, eventually finding it under the Manage Goals page.
- The expectation was that goal creation and other common operations would be accessible directly from the dashboard, without requiring navigation to a separate page.
- The participant suggested surfacing a goal creation shortcut on the dashboard to reduce the number of steps required for this frequent action.

Overall Experience

- The visual design was described as pleasant and polished.
- The participant expressed that the application was enjoyable to use overall.

6 Observed usability problems

One main usability issue was extracted from the session observations.

Issue 1 — Low Discoverability of Goal Creation

The goal creation workflow is only accessible via the Manage Goals page, which is not immediately apparent from the dashboard. Users expect frequent operations to be reachable within one interaction from the primary view. Having to navigate away to perform a common action increases friction and reduces perceived efficiency.

7 Planned improvements after this feedback

Based on the session findings, the following changes are planned for the final development sprint:

- Add a goal creation shortcut directly on the dashboard, allowing users to create a new goal without navigating to the Manage Goals page.
- Review the dashboard to identify other frequent operations that could be surfaced at the top level, reducing reliance on secondary pages for common tasks.

8 Reflection

This session confirmed that the improvements implemented after the first evaluation were effective: onboarding, repository connection, and the overall interface were all received positively without prompting. The application has reached a level of polish where first-time users can navigate and understand its core value independently.

The one issue identified — the discoverability of goal creation — is consistent with a general design principle that frequent actions should be accessible from the primary view. Addressing this in the final sprint will further reduce friction for new users and improve the overall task efficiency of the application. The positive reception of the visual design and the ease of the core workflow suggest that the application is well-positioned for final submission.

9 Screenshots of Adopted Changes

